

History of English Literature - Important MCQs (Part 54)

Page 267 - Novelists of the Transition

Q1. Which play is NOT written by John Galsworthy?

- A. Strife
- B. The Silver Box
- C. The Voysey Inheritance
- D. The Skin Game

Answer: C

Q2. Who is the author of the naturalistic play 'The Voysey Inheritance'?

- A. John Galsworthy
- B. Harley Granville-Barker
- C. Arnold Bennett
- D. Edward Knoblock

Answer: B

Q3. 'Milestones' is a study in the dynamics of progress by Arnold Bennett and:

- A. John Masefield
- B. Harley Granville-Barker
- C. Edward Knoblock
- D. George Moore

Answer: C

Q4. Which of the following is a contribution to modern tragic drama by John Masefield?

- A. Pompey the Great
- B. The Tragedy of Nan
- C. Good Friday
- D. All of the above

Answer: D

Q5. From about 1885 onward, English novelists began to treat realistic themes:

- A. In a romantic manner
- B. Dispassionately and non-sentimentally

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- C. With extreme sentimentality
- D. Through historical allegories

Answer: B

Q6. George Moore's 'Esther Waters' was a landmark in the movement toward:

- A. Romanticism
- B. Aesthetic realism
- C. Naturalism
- D. Symbolism

Answer: B

Q7. George Gissing wrote a number of grim novels close to:

- A. The facts of life he had observed
- B. Medieval romance
- C. Gothic traditions
- D. Utopian ideals

Answer: A

Q8. Which Gissing novel introduces much slightly-veiled autobiography?

- A. Esther Waters
- B. Born in Exile
- C. The Silver Box
- D. Milestones

Answer: B

Q9. What weakens George Gissing's fiction despite its literary integrity?

- A. Excessive romanticism
- B. A note of whining resentment and self-pity
- C. Lack of realism
- D. Overuse of comedy

Answer: B

Q10. In his later years, George Gissing wrote a book of reflections in fine prose titled:

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- A. The Private Papers of Henry Ryecroft
- B. Born in Exile
- C. The Voysey Inheritance
- D. Esther Waters

Answer: A

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Page 268 - George Moore and Rudyard Kipling

Q1. George Moore's 'The Brook Kerith' deals with the legend that Jesus lived on among the:

- A. Pharisees
- B. Essene monastic community
- C. Romans
- D. Sadducees

Answer: B

Q2. Which of the following is NOT a historical novel by George Moore?

- A. The Brook Kerith
- B. Abelard and Heloise
- C. Ulick and Soracha
- D. The Private Papers of Henry Ryecroft

Answer: D

Q3. In his final period, George Moore's prose style austere rejected:

- A. Clarity
- B. Precision
- C. Verbal ornamentation
- D. Inner beauty

Answer: C

Q4. Who had no equal among English short-story writers of the traditional type according to the text?

- A. Rudyard Kipling
- B. George Moore
- C. George Gissing
- D. Arnold Bennett

Answer: A

Q5. Rudyard Kipling widened the range of fiction with stories of:

- A. Aristocracy and nobility
- B. Machinery and animals

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C. Medieval knights

D. Urban slums

Answer: B

Q6. Which novel by Rudyard Kipling is considered comparable in merit with his short stories?

A. Kim

B. The Brook Kerith

C. Pickwick

D. Esther Waters

Answer: A

Q7. Kipling's 'Kim' does for the Tibetan borderland what 'Pickwick' did for:

A. Scotland

B. Ireland

C. England

D. Wales

Answer: C

Q8. 'A Gentleman of France' and 'The House of the Wolf' were written by:

A. Maurice Hewlett

B. Stanley Weyman

C. Anthony Hope

D. Conan Doyle

Answer: B

Q9. Maurice Hewlett's 'The Forest Lovers' and Anthony Hope's 'The Prisoner of Zenda' are products of the:

A. Realistic movement

B. Romantic imagination

C. Naturalistic theater

D. Historical biographies

Answer: B

Q10. Who is the author of 'Sherlock Holmes'?

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- A. Stanley Weyman
- B. Maurice Hewlett
- C. Conan Doyle
- D. Anthony Hope

Answer: C

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Page 269 - Twentieth Century Novelists

Q1. After Dickens' death, the custody of tradition in the English novel was vested in:

- A. Meredith and Hardy
- B. Wells and Conrad
- C. Bennett and Galsworthy
- D. Moore and Gissing

Answer: A

Q2. 'The Time Machine' was one of the early fantastic romances of:

- A. Joseph Conrad
- B. H.G. Wells
- C. Henry James
- D. Arnold Bennett

Answer: B

Q3. Which of the following novels established H.G. Wells as a novelist with a special genius for comedy?

- A. The Time Machine
- B. Love and Mr. Lewisham
- C. Tono-Bungay
- D. Lord Jim

Answer: B

Q4. Many people ranked which book as H.G. Wells' best novel?

- A. The History of Mr. Polly
- B. Tono-Bungay
- C. Mr. Britling Sees It Through
- D. Kipps

Answer: B

Q5. In 'Tono-Bungay', the national change from aristocracy to democracy is seen through the mind of:

- A. Mr. Lewisham
- B. Mr. Polly

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C. George Ponderevo

D. Mr. Britling

Answer: C

Q6. From 1912 onward, H.G. Wells believed that the novel should serve as a platform for:

A. Entertainment only

B. Propagation of ideas and social discussion

C. Pure aesthetic art

D. Historical romance

Answer: B

Q7. Joseph Conrad's original name was:

A. Josef Konrad Korzeniowski

B. Joseph Conrad Korzeniowski

C. Josef Conrad Korzeniowski

D. Josef Konrad

Answer: A

Q8. Before settling in England to write, Joseph Conrad served on:

A. British naval warships

B. French and British merchant ships

C. Polish merchant ships

D. American whaling ships

Answer: B

Q9. Which of the following is considered one of Conrad's penetrating psychological novels?

A. Typhoon

B. Chance

C. The Nigger of the 'Narcissus'

D. Tono-Bungay

Answer: B

Q10. Who was the Anglicized-American author whose example of making the novel a work of art Conrad

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followed?

- A. Henry James
- B. Mark Twain
- C. Herman Melville
- D. Walt Whitman

Answer: A

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Page 270 - Joseph Conrad and Traditional Novelists

Q1. Joseph Conrad's narrative method is described as:

- A. Simple and straightforward
- B. Peculiarly involved and sometimes perplexing
- C. Entirely episodic
- D. Strictly chronological

Answer: B

Q2. Which novel by Conrad is described as 'near to the absolute greatness of poetic tragedy'?

- A. Victory
- B. Lord Jim
- C. Chance
- D. Typhoon

Answer: B

Q3. Conrad's 'Victory' is placed lower than 'Lord Jim' because it plunges into:

- A. Exotic romanticism
- B. Didacticism
- C. Harsh realism
- D. Historical fantasy

Answer: A

Q4. A unifying idea running through Conrad's novels is the imperative need for:

- A. Political revolution
- B. Loyalty to a human principle
- C. Individual isolation
- D. Economic success

Answer: B

Q5. According to Conrad, against the treachery of the ocean, what must be maintained?

- A. Strict discipline
- B. Human solidarity

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C. Advanced technology

D. Blind faith

Answer: B

Q6. In 'Lord Jim', after breaking human solidarity, what must be made?

A. A swift escape

B. Atonement after travail

C. A public confession

D. A financial settlement

Answer: B

Q7. 'The Old Wives' Tale' and 'Clayhanger' were written by:

A. Arnold Bennett

B. John Galsworthy

C. Joseph Conrad

D. H.G. Wells

Answer: A

Q8. John Galsworthy's 'The Forsyte Saga' gives a picture of which social classes in modern England?

A. The typical middle-class in trade

B. The professional and aristocratic classes

C. The working class

D. The agricultural peasantry

Answer: B

Q9. Arnold Bennett's literary style is described as:

A. Graceful and suave

B. Efficient workmanlike middle-class prose

C. Poetic and impressionistic

D. Complex and deeply psychological

Answer: B

Q10. Which of the following is an accurate description of Galsworthy's literary style?

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- A. Efficient and workmanlike
- B. Graceful and suave
- C. Rugged and brutal
- D. Complicated and perplexing

Answer: B

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Page 271 - Miscellaneous Prose

Q1. Arnold Bennett wrote a first-rate humorous novel titled:

- A. Buried Alive
- B. The Great Adventure
- C. Over Bemerton's
- D. Joseph Vance

Answer: A

Q2. William De Morgan spent the main part of his life designing and manufacturing:

- A. Textiles
- B. Ceramics
- C. Furniture
- D. Jewelry

Answer: B

Q3. When did William De Morgan turn to novel-writing?

- A. While recovering from an illness
- B. During his youth
- C. After retiring from politics
- D. During World War I

Answer: A

Q4. Which of the following is NOT one of William De Morgan's best first three novels?

- A. Joseph Vance
- B. Alice-for-Short
- C. Somehow Good
- D. Buried Alive

Answer: D

Q5. De Morgan's novels excelled in:

- A. Humour and controlled pathos
- B. Naturalistic tragedy

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C. Psychological suspense

D. Political satire

Answer: A

Q6. Revolutionary changes in journalism in the late 19th century were influenced by Alfred Harmsworth, T.P. O'Connor, and:

A. Bernard Shaw

B. Max Beerbohm

C. A.G. Gardiner

D. Robert Lynd

Answer: A

Q7. Which essayist wrote under the pseudonym 'Alpha of the Plough'?

A. Robert Lynd

B. E.V. Lucas

C. A.G. Gardiner

D. Max Beerbohm

Answer: C

Q8. E.V. Lucas made a definite mark with 'Over Bemerton's', combining qualities of a familiar essay and:

A. A drama

B. A poem

C. A novel

D. A biography

Answer: C

Q9. Who was the most brilliant caricaturist of his generation and a parodist of genius?

A. E.V. Lucas

B. Max Beerbohm

C. Kenneth Grahame

D. A.A. Milne

Answer: B

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Q10. 'The Golden Age', 'Dream Days', and 'The Wind in the Willows' were written by:

A. Kenneth Grahame

B. A.A. Milne

C. Max Beerbohm

D. C.M. Doughty

Answer: A